

LIVING AND WORKING WITH AI

Your choices matter.

Understand a changing world.

Build useful skills.

Choose your next step.

Eight lessons · Adult beginners

Paper and conversation are enough.

01 Learn.

What is happening?

What can I understand or practise?

02 Question.

What supports this?

Who could be affected?

03 Decide.

What will I do, and why?

What could change my mind?

New evidence? Return to Learn.

Course map

Course home

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Eight complete lessons take you from a small everyday choice to decisions about work, society and your own learning. No additional lesson is required to complete this edition.

Route	Central question	Work you can demonstrate
<u>1. Everyday life</u>	Where could AI help, and what needs checking?	Correct a message and explain a choice
<u>2. Working with AI</u>	How can I explain a task and improve the result?	Write a brief and adapt an agenda to changed conditions
<u>3. Evidence and trust</u>	What deserves my trust?	Trace a claim and update it when new evidence arrives
<u>4. Changing work</u>	Which tasks could change, and who shapes that change?	Map work, compare a whole task and propose a shared improvement
<u>5. AI in society</u>	Who benefits, who faces barriers and who can influence a decision?	Examine participation data and explain a public-service trade-off
<u>6. Skills worth developing</u>	How can I strengthen knowledge, judgment and collaboration?	Explain a method and use it on a changed example
<u>7. Responsibility and choice</u>	What information, review and human involvement fit the situation?	Set boundaries and question a selection rule
<u>8. Your next 30 days</u>	What small action is worth taking now?	Connect the lessons in a final case and build a learning plan

Three connected perspectives

My task: understand, create and check. Lessons 1–3 establish this foundation.

Our work and society: examine opportunity, burdens and shared decisions. Lessons 4–5 broaden the view.

My contribution and next step: practise skills, take responsibility and keep learning. Lessons 6–8 bring the ideas into action.

These perspectives overlap. Revisit the earlier questions when a new situation is difficult. Completing the route means attempting and explaining choices, not agreeing with every example answer.

Optional routes into the existing library

- New to digital tools: Computers and Internet.
- More practice evaluating claims: Learning and information checking.
- Preparing for a workplace task: AI at work and Working well.
- Exploring longer-term possibilities: Adult future scenarios.

Choose an optional link because it serves a goal. No linked course is a prerequisite.

AI in your everyday life

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Lesson 1 of 8 · Adult beginners · About 20–25 minutes, at your own pace

By the end: you can identify what AI helped produce, check it against supplied facts and choose a next step with a reason.

A message that looks ready

Lina helps at a neighbourhood bicycle repair shop. She has three notes for a customer update:

Fictional workshop notes

The bicycle has arrived. Inspection has not started. The workshop has not confirmed a collection date.

An AI assistant produces this draft:

“Good news! We have inspected your bicycle and it will be ready on Friday.”

The message is friendly. It is also wrong in two important ways. Before reading on, point to the words that the notes do not support.

Learn — recognise the kind of help

AI is a broad name for computer systems that use inputs to produce outputs such as predictions, recommendations or generated content. This course focuses mainly on generative AI: tools that can produce words, pictures and other content. Different systems have different abilities.

For example, a system may suggest wording, recommend an item or sort a request into a category. These outputs can influence what people see and do next. This course starts with a message you can inspect, then widens the view to decisions about work and shared services.

You might encounter a generated explanation, a translation suggestion or a list of ideas. Some applications also connect to tools that search, save or send. Writing a message and sending it are separate events. A generated sentence saying “I sent it” is not enough to establish that a message was sent.

In Lina's story, the assistant helped turn notes into a draft. It did not establish the bicycle's condition or the collection date. Clear wording and factual support need separate checks. NIST identifies confidently presented false content as a generative-AI risk. [Background source](#)

Lina could still use assistance for the wording. She could also write the short message herself. A useful choice depends on the task and the checking it needs.

Question — go back to the evidence

Use three questions:

1. **What supports this?** Compare each important claim with the notes.
2. **What is missing?** Keep unknown details visible.
3. **Who could be affected?** Imagine the customer arranging a journey around a promised date.

“We have inspected” conflicts with “inspection has not started.” “Ready on Friday” adds a date that was never confirmed. Asking the same assistant whether it is certain would not provide evidence from the workshop.

A corrected draft is:

“Your bicycle has arrived. Inspection has not started yet, and the collection date is still to be confirmed.”

It is useful because it preserves the actual state. The shop can add a confirmed next step once it has one.

Decide — choose an action you can explain

Lina chooses to revise the draft, check the current workshop record and follow the shop's normal process for sending it. If the record has changed, the message should change too.

Her reason is simple: “I want the customer to receive an accurate update.” Her decision remains open to new evidence.

Your choices matter here means you can ask questions and take responsibility for your part. The shop also has responsibilities: clear records, workable review time and tools employees are permitted to use.

Your turn — make a useful choice

Use this new fictional notice:

A community repair session is on 12 June, from 10:00 to 11:00, in Cedar Room. Attendance is free. Participants should bring one item of clothing. Booking requirements have not been supplied.

An invented assistant draft says:

“Drop in on 12 June from 10:00 to 12:00. No booking needed. Bring your bicycle.”

On paper or aloud:

1. Find two contradictions and one unsupported claim.
2. Write a corrected version using the room and cost as well.
3. Name one question to settle before sharing the notice.
4. Choose whether you would edit this short message yourself or use AI to help. Explain your choice.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The finish time should be 11:00, and the item should be clothing. “No booking needed” is unsupported.

One corrected version: “Join the free repair session in Cedar Room on 12 June, 10:00–11:00. Bring one item of clothing. Booking requirements are still to be confirmed.”

Ask the organiser whether booking is needed. A year or address may also be needed for a real announcement. Either writing method is reasonable if you can explain it and check the result.

Try a different situation

A fictional hobby newsletter asks for three titles for a story about a lost umbrella. Which part could AI help with? How would your check differ from the repair notice?

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

AI could suggest titles; you choose one that fits the story and your intended tone. A creative preference can have several good answers. An event time needs factual support. If a suggested title makes a factual claim, that part still needs checking.

Take it with you

Complete one sentence: “For my next small task, I will learn ___, question ___, and decide ___ because ___.”

You can use the [choice worksheet](#). Your reason matters more than matching another learner's answer.

[Next: Working with AI](#) · [Course home](#)

Working with AI

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Lesson 2 of 8 · Adult beginners · About 25–35 minutes, at your own pace

By the end: you can describe a useful task, compare a response with your requirements and improve the result without giving away the decision.

An idea needs a shape

Arun is organising a small community skill-sharing session. He asks an assistant, “Give me something exciting.” It suggests a competition, a video presentation and an online sign-up campaign. None fits the quiet, informal gathering he imagined.

The problem is partly the missing brief. Arun knows what the participants need; he has not yet explained it. A fluent response cannot tell him whether those missing requirements have been met.

Learn — give the task a useful brief

A **prompt** is an instruction or question given to an AI system. A useful brief can contain five things:

Part	Arun's fictional brief
Purpose	Help four adults share a practical skill in a friendly session
Supplied information	Thirty minutes; one room; paper and pens available
Boundaries	No internet, purchases or competition; everyone may choose to observe
Desired result	Two possible agendas with times and materials
Check	Add the times; check the materials and participation choices

He could give the same brief to a human helper. Explaining a task is a transferable skill.

A more useful request is: “Using these details, suggest two 30-minute agendas. Include a quiet participation option. Use paper and pens only. List any important question you need answered rather than inventing the answer.”

Specific instructions help define what you want; they do not guarantee compliance or accuracy. An assistant's statement that it followed every instruction still needs checking against the actual result.

Question — compare with the brief

Arun receives these **invented responses**:

Agenda A	Agenda B
Welcome: 5 minutes	Welcome: 5 minutes
Pair skill-sharing: 10 minutes	Online quiz: 10 minutes
Write or sketch a useful tip: 10 minutes	Speed competition: 10 minutes
Optional sharing and close: 5 minutes	Awards and close: 5 minutes

Both total 30 minutes. Agenda B conflicts with the no-internet and no-competition requirements. Agenda A is closer, but Arun should make the option to observe clear throughout, including the pair activity.

He also asks whether the participants can use the room and materials comfortably. The brief may need a question about access; an assistant cannot discover every need from a short description.

Decide — revise with a reason

Arun chooses A and writes: “During each activity, participants can speak, write, sketch or observe. No one must demonstrate a skill.” He asks the organiser about access needs before finalising arrangements.

His working sequence is:

Describe the task → examine the response → revise → decide what to use.

If the purpose changes, return to the brief.

He can ask for a limited revision: “Keep the 30-minute total. Make the participation options explicit. Do not add materials.” He can also edit it himself. More conversation with AI is useful only when it moves the work towards the goal.

Your turn — make the request and check the result

Use this fictional task card:

Plan a 20-minute indoor welcome activity for six adults. Paper and pens are available. No internet, purchases or compulsory speaking. Include time to explain the activity and close it.

An invented response proposes: “Five-minute introduction, ten-minute online quiz, ten-minute round in which everyone gives a speech.”

1. Write a brief using the five parts above.
2. Identify the time problem and two other conflicts.
3. Make a revised agenda and explain one choice.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The response totals 25 minutes, includes internet use and requires speaking. A workable revision is: explanation 3 minutes; individual writing or sketching 7; optional pair sharing or quiet reflection 7; close 3. The total is 20. Paper and pens suffice, and observing is also welcome.

A useful brief names all the task-card constraints and asks for a timed agenda. Several agendas could work. Explain how yours serves the group rather than trying to reproduce these exact words.

Try a different situation

The organiser now says: “We have only 12 minutes, and no paper or pens.” Design a shorter activity with optional speaking. Would asking the assistant to “make the same plan faster” explain enough?

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The materials changed as well as the time. State both changes. One option is: explanation 2 minutes; quiet thought about a useful skill 4; optional conversation or continued reflection 4; close 2. Nothing has to be written down. Ask about any access needs this activity should accommodate.

The new result needs a new check. A plan that met yesterday's brief may not meet today's.

Take it with you

Use the [task-brief worksheet](#). Choose a small task you understand well enough to judge. You can practise entirely with the supplied examples.

[Previous: Everyday life](#) · [Next: Evidence and trust](#) · [Course home](#)

Evidence and trust

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Lesson 3 of 8 · Adult beginners · About 25–35 minutes, at your own pace

By the end: you can trace a claim to its evidence, distinguish a proposal from a decision and explain what remains uncertain.

Three repetitions, one source

Farah sees a social-media message: “The community library will replace all its staff with AI next month.” A second post repeats it. An AI-generated summary repeats it too.

She feels worried. Seeing the claim three times makes it familiar. Before passing it on, she opens the supplied source cards below.

All three cards are invented for this lesson.

A — Library planning note, 2 March: “We propose trying an automated catalogue-help desk for four weeks. Staff would remain available. The board has not decided whether to approve the trial.”

B — Community post, 3 March: “AI replaces all library staff next month!” The post links only to card A.

C — Assistant summary, 4 March: “Several reports say staff replacement is imminent.” Its references are card B and another post that quotes B.

Learn — follow the claim back

Evidence is information that helps support or challenge a particular claim. A useful check asks **who said what, when, on what basis, and about which situation**.

Cards B and C do not provide independent confirmation. They lead back to A, which says something different. Card A supports the existence of a proposal. It does not establish approval, a launch date or staff replacement.

An original source can also be incomplete, mistaken or out of date. “Original” is a starting point for checking, not a promise of truth. For a current decision, look for a current decision record or ask the responsible organisation.

Generative AI can produce confident false content, including misleading supporting material. That is one reason to open and examine a cited source instead of treating a citation-shaped sentence as evidence. [NIST background, section 2.2](#)

Question — separate four kinds of statement

Statement	What kind is it?	What would help assess it?
"A trial has been proposed"	Claim about a recorded event	The planning note and its context
"The board will approve it"	Prediction	Reasons and uncertainty; later, the actual decision
"The library should retain human help"	Value or policy preference	Reasons, affected people's needs and alternatives
"The trial improved access"	Claim about an outcome	Defined measures, relevant observations and comparison

These can all belong in a discussion, but they do different jobs. A prediction should not quietly become a fact. A value judgment needs reasons even when no single measurement settles it.

Pictures and recordings need context too. A clip may be generated, edited, mislabelled or taken from another occasion. Appearance alone does not settle the event, date or meaning. Seek the source and relevant corroboration; sometimes "I cannot verify this yet" is the most accurate conclusion.

Decide — communicate what you know

Farah decides not to repeat the staff-replacement claim. She writes:

"The supplied library note describes a proposed four-week help-desk trial, with staff remaining available. Approval is not confirmed in that note. I would check the board's current decision before saying the trial will happen."

She can still discuss whether the proposal is a good idea. Keeping evidence and opinion distinct makes that discussion clearer.

Your turn — repair an exaggerated claim

Use these fictional records:

A test involved five volunteer readers. Three completed a catalogue task without help; two asked a librarian. There was no comparison with the previous service. The report did not measure waiting time or staffing needs.

A promotional summary says: "The test proves everyone can use the system independently, and it halves the need for staff."

1. Identify two claims the record does not support.
2. Write a careful two-sentence summary.
3. Name one question worth investigating next.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The “everyone independently” claim conflicts with two people asking for help. No staffing comparison supports the claim about halving staff needs.

One summary: “In this small five-person test, three readers completed the task without help and two asked a librarian. The record does not establish how the system compares with the previous service or what staffing it needs.”

Useful next questions concern varied access needs, mistakes, time spent by staff or performance on different tasks. Five volunteers cannot stand in for every reader.

Try a different situation

A later fictional board notice says: “We approved the four-week trial. Staff will remain available throughout. We have made no decision about service after the trial.”

Which parts of Farah's earlier summary should change? Does this notice establish that the trial succeeds?

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

Approval is now confirmed, so replace the earlier uncertainty about approval. Human help remains part of the stated plan. Results and later arrangements are still unknown. New evidence can resolve one question while leaving others open.

Take it with you

Use the [evidence worksheet](#): claim, source, support, missing information and a proportionate next step.

[Previous: Working with AI](#) · [Next: Changing work](#) · [Course home](#)

How AI could change your work

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Lesson 4 of 8 · Adult beginners · About 30–40 minutes, at your own pace

By the end: you can examine a job as a set of tasks, identify a useful skill to practise and name a decision an organisation should address.

You can use a job, volunteering role or the supplied fictional shop. You do not need to be employed or share private workplace information.

A job contains many kinds of work

Lina's bicycle shop is considering AI assistance. One person says, “It can write customer messages, so it can do Lina's job.” Another says, “It sometimes makes mistakes, so it cannot help us at all.”

Both statements skip the details. Lina also clarifies requests, coordinates with the workshop and listens when a customer is worried. Start by looking at the tasks.

Learn — map the work

Task exposure means a task could be affected by a technology's capabilities. It does not establish that a particular employer will adopt it or that a job will disappear. The ILO studies tasks within occupations; its 2026 explanation warns against treating exposure indicators alone as predictions of job losses. [ILO research](#), [indicator limits](#)

Use this invented work map as a starting point:

Task	Assistance worth exploring	Human work to practise
Organise supplied repair requests	Suggest groups or summaries	Notice omissions and understand urgency
Draft a customer update	Suggest clear wording	Verify facts and commitments
Compare supplied costs	Arrange a comparison	Recalculate totals and explain trade-offs
Discuss a repair diagnosis	Suggest questions or reference leads	Apply relevant technical expertise
Respond to a worried customer	Help prepare possible wording	Listen, clarify and take responsibility

These are possibilities to evaluate, not a forecast or proof that a particular tool performs them well. The combination of tasks, people and conditions matters.

Question — whose experience improves?

Suppose a tool reduces drafting time. What happens to that time?

Consider three **possible choices by the fictional shop**, rather than three predictions:

- **More time with customers:** the shop uses some time for clearer explanations and provides training.
- **More pressure:** the shop increases the number of messages expected but provides no time to check them.
- **Selective use:** the shop keeps assistance for a few useful drafts and handles other tasks in its usual way.

The same capability can be used differently. Ask who benefits, who carries extra checking work, how beginners gain experience and how staff can raise problems. Workers can contribute knowledge about the real task; managers and providers must address resources and design.

This question also reaches society. Imagine a community service introducing an automated enquiry desk. Faster answers might help some people, while people who cannot use the interface need another route. A sensible discussion asks about accuracy, access and human help together.

Looking further ahead

Imagine three possible changes at the shop: a routine drafting task takes less time; checking and explaining results takes more attention; a new responsibility appears for maintaining useful examples and helping colleagues learn. These possibilities could change the mix of work without moving in the same direction for every person.

There are also harder possibilities: fewer paid hours, an entry-level task disappearing, or training that is available only to some staff. The task-exposure research does not tell us which outcome this shop will experience. Ask what the organisation actually plans, how staff can contribute and what support would accompany a change.

For your own development, look for an adjacent contribution: what useful part of the work could you understand or perform better? Lina could practise explaining technical information clearly. A colleague could practise checking a cost comparison. These are options to explore, not promises of job security. Organisations and public institutions also shape opportunities, training and support.

Decide — choose a small experiment and a shared question

Lina proposes practising on invented notes, comparing the result with a manual draft and asking the manager how review time would be provided. She wants to strengthen clear writing and customer communication whether or not the shop adopts the tool.

She does not have to predict her whole career. She can choose a useful next skill and ask to participate in decisions that affect the work.

Your turn — compare the whole task

These invented timings describe one exercise:

Method	Drafting	Checking	Corrections	Total
Manual	12 minutes	5 minutes	3 minutes	20 minutes
Assisted	4 minutes	8 minutes	6 minutes	?

1. Calculate the assisted total and the difference.
2. Explain why that difference alone does not settle which method is better.
3. Choose one row from the work map. Name a skill you would practise and how someone could observe it.
4. Write one question for a manager about introducing assistance fairly.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The assisted total is 18 minutes, two minutes less than 20. This one fictional comparison does not establish equal quality, accessibility or a general saving. Both drafts must meet the same requirements; training and tool costs would also matter in a real decision.

A useful skill goal is: “I will write a clear update from unfamiliar notes and explain which fact supports each sentence.” A manager question could be: “How will checking time and training be included in the workload?” Other questions about worker input, accessibility or correction responsibility are equally useful.

Try a different situation

A tool drafts the same kind of message in 2 minutes, but checking takes 15 and correction takes 6. A colleague says, “The draft is faster, so the job is faster.”

What would you say? Then name one reason the organisation might still investigate the tool.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The full task takes 23 minutes, three more than the manual example. Faster drafting did not make this example faster overall. The organisation might investigate a different benefit, such as a useful format or language option, but would need to evaluate it. Speed is one consideration.

Take it with you

Use the [work-and-skills map](#). Choose one task to understand, one skill to strengthen and one organisational question to raise.

Your choices matter. So do access, training, time and the choices of people who organise work. An uncertain future is a reason to keep learning and participating, without blaming yourself for conditions you cannot control.

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AI in society

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Lesson 5 of 8 · Adult beginners · About 30–40 minutes, at your own pace

By the end: you can compare possible social outcomes, identify whose experience is missing and propose a change that makes a shared service more accountable.

A faster service for whom?

Farah attends an open discussion at the fictional Riverside community centre. The centre is considering AI to sort activity requests and suggest which new classes to offer.

One resident hopes this will reveal overlooked interests. Another worries that the centre will listen mainly to people who use its app. A staff member wants less repetitive administration and more time helping visitors.

These concerns can all be reasonable. Understanding the proposal means looking beyond what the software can produce.

Learn — see the decisions around the system

Some AI generates content; other systems classify, rank or recommend. In this story the system groups requests and recommends priorities. The centre still chooses the purpose, information collected, purchasing arrangement and rules for acting on results.

Follow the chain:

Stage	A human or institutional choice
People express needs	Which languages and contact routes are available?
Requests become data	Are repeat messages, missing responses and context understood?
A system produces suggestions	What is it trying to improve, and how is it checked?
The centre allocates resources	Who can question the recommendation before it affects people?
People experience the service	Who measures access, benefit, mistakes and correction?

AI's effects depend partly on choices throughout this chain. A high score for speed alone cannot tell the centre whether the service meets its purpose.

UNESCO's AI ethics recommendation connects AI with fairness, human oversight, inclusion and environmental concerns. NIST also treats trustworthiness as involving social and organisational conditions. These are useful lenses for asking questions, not proof that a particular system meets them. [UNESCO](#), [NIST](#)

Question — compare possible futures

Imagine three possible arrangements at Riverside. These are scenarios, not forecasts:

- **Broader participation:** staff combine app, telephone and in-person requests. They check patterns with residents and use saved administrative time for support.
- **A narrow picture:** app messages become the main measure of demand. Repeated messages dominate, and people outside the app become less visible.
- **More dependence on a supplier:** the service works well initially, but a price or policy change leaves the centre without an affordable way to retrieve its records or continue the service.

Different futures can overlap. Ask what evidence would reveal each one early and who has power to change the arrangement.

Wider society presents similar choices: schools decide how learners practise; employers decide how gains and burdens are shared; public bodies decide how people can obtain help or challenge an outcome. Communities can ask about resource use and environmental costs alongside financial costs. This course supplies no universal footprint estimate: the relevant system, use and comparison would need evidence.

Decide — turn a concern into a proposal

Farah proposes: “Count different people's requests, keep a non-app route, and check whether participation broadens. Have staff explain the final choices and provide a way to correct missing information.”

She also asks what happens if the system becomes unavailable. The centre can consider a bounded trial, change the proposal or retain its current process.

One person cannot control the whole arrangement. People can still contribute through a staff discussion, residents' meeting, learner group or other suitable local channel. People responsible for the service must provide meaningful ways to participate.

Your turn — question the measurement

These invented figures describe responses during one consultation:

Area	App messages	Different app participants	Residents in the area
North	80	40	200

Area	App messages	Different app participants	Residents in the area
South	20	20	200

An assistant suggests: “Give North four times as many new classes because its need is four times greater.”

1. What was counted four times as often? What was counted twice as often?
2. Why do neither of those comparisons establish the whole community's need?
3. Name a possible benefit of analysing requests and a missing perspective.
4. Propose two checks before deciding where to offer classes.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

North sent four times as many messages (80 compared with 20) and had twice as many different app participants (40 compared with 20). These are different measurements. Equal area populations do not make app participation representative or tell us what non-participants need.

Grouping requests could help staff notice interests. People who did not use the app are missing, and repeated messages can distort the picture. Checks could include telephone or in-person consultation, looking at which activities are requested and asking why people did not participate. No exact allocation follows from this table alone.

Try a different situation

Riverside has already gathered requests through several routes. Now a proposed ranking rule favours activities with the highest predicted attendance. A small group requests a quieter session that would meet an access need but attract fewer people.

Is “count more people” enough to settle this choice? State one question and one possible arrangement.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

Better participation data would help, but the purpose of the service also matters. Ask whether the centre aims only to maximise attendance or also to provide access for smaller groups. One arrangement could combine larger sessions with a quieter session, subject to available space and staff. Explain the trade-off openly; a prediction cannot choose the centre's values for it.

Take it with you

Complete the [shared-choice worksheet](#). Record a possible benefit, someone whose perspective is missing, a question for the responsible organisation and evidence that could change your view.

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Skills worth developing

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Lesson 6 of 8 · Adult beginners · About 25–35 minutes, at your own pace

By the end: you can choose a skill worth practising, use help with a clear purpose and demonstrate what you understand on a changed example.

A good result, an unanswered question

Lina uses a worked example to prepare a neat summary of shop activity. A colleague asks, “Why did you calculate it that way?” She finds that she can point to the answer but cannot yet explain it.

The summary may be useful. Her learning goal needs a separate check. She wants to understand the method well enough to notice when it does not fit.

Learn — choose skills that serve your purpose

No course can promise a list of skills that guarantees future employment. Start with a task or contribution that matters to you.

Skill to strengthen	What practice could look like
Knowledge of your subject	Explain a concept and recognise when specialist help is needed
Clear communication	Turn notes into an explanation for a particular reader
Evidence and number sense	Check a claim, total or comparison and describe its limits
Collaboration	Listen, clarify different needs and agree who will do what
Creative judgment	Produce alternatives and explain why one fits the purpose
Learning and revision	Try, examine feedback and change your approach

AI may provide examples, practice questions or alternative wording. A person, book, calculator or other reference can also help. Choose assistance according to the goal and your access needs. Using an accessibility aid does not make your understanding less your own.

For this course, try a practice cycle:

Attempt → study feedback → explain → try a changed example.

Keep the help you need. Remove the sample answer when checking whether you understand the idea.

This is a teaching routine to try, not a measured promise about learning speed.

Question — what can you explain?

Use this invented example. The shop holds three open advice sessions. Visits are 12, 18 and 0. All three sessions took place, including the one nobody attended.

The mean, often called the average, is the total divided by the number of sessions:

$$(12 + 18 + 0) \div 3 = 30 \div 3 = 10 \text{ visits per session.}$$

An invented assistant answer gives 15 by leaving out the zero. That answers a different question: the average among sessions that had at least one visitor.

Ask what each number represents and which question you want answered. An explanation is more useful than memorising “always divide by three.” The number of sessions could change.

You may use a calculator. The skill here is selecting and explaining the calculation, not mental arithmetic.

Decide — match help to the learning goal

Lina asks a willing colleague to change the numbers after she has explained the first example. She can also ask an assistant for a practice question and check its answer against the method supplied here.

She chooses a small goal: “I can say what is included in an average and why.” If this is still difficult, she starts with totals before returning to averages. If she already knows it, she chooses a more relevant skill from the table.

Her progress is something she can demonstrate, not the sophistication of the tool she used.

Your turn — explain a changed example

Four fictional advice sessions took place. Visits were 0, 6, 12 and 18. An assistant reports an average of 12 after excluding the zero.

1. Calculate the total and mean across **all four sessions**. You can use a calculator or ask someone to read the numbers aloud.
2. Explain why the zero belongs in this question.
3. Explain which different question the answer 12 would address.
4. Choose one skill from the table and describe evidence that you could demonstrate it.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The total is 36, and $36 \div 4 = 9$ visits per session. The zero belongs because that session took place and the question includes all four. Dividing by the three sessions with visitors gives 12; that describes only sessions with at least one visitor.

A skill demonstration could be explaining an unfamiliar record, writing for a new audience or adapting a design to changed requirements. “I watched a tutorial” describes an activity; it does not yet show what you can do.

Try a different situation

Now practise creative judgment. A community class needs a title that welcomes beginners and does not promise expertise. Two invented suggestions are “Become an AI Expert in One Hour” and “A First Conversation about AI.”

Choose or revise a title and explain your reason. How would you demonstrate this skill on a new example?

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The second title better fits the supplied purpose. The first promises expertise that the brief does not support. Other titles can work. To demonstrate the skill again, adapt a title for a different audience or purpose and explain the fit. This task has several reasonable answers; the average task had a specific numerical answer.

Take it with you

Use the [skill-practice worksheet](#). Record the help you used, what you can explain and a fresh example you will try. Choose a pace that fits your circumstances.

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Responsibility and choice

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Lesson 7 of 8 · Adult beginners · About 25–35 minutes, at your own pace

By the end: you can set a reasonable boundary for an AI-assisted task, identify who needs to review it and explain when to change or stop the proposed use.

Useful assistance, an important boundary

Arun wants help grouping suggestions for a community event. A spreadsheet contains ideas, names, contact details and personal notes explaining why some people need particular arrangements.

The task is to understand the suggestions. The whole spreadsheet contains more information than that task needs. Arun also does not know whether the centre permits this tool for participant information.

Learn — connect the task to its consequences

Consider four questions before using a tool:

Question	In Arun's fictional situation
What information is needed?	Activity suggestions; names and contact details are unnecessary for this practice
Who has a say?	The centre's responsible organiser and the people whose information is involved
What can the tool do?	Suggest groups; sending messages or changing records would be separate actions
Who checks and corrects?	Arun can check the grouping; the organiser owns the decision about the actual event

NIST's framework treats privacy, accountability and reliable performance as connected considerations. The appropriate arrangement depends on the use and its effects. [NIST background](#)

For this exercise, use the invented suggestion cards below. For a real organisational task, follow the relevant rules and use approved tools and information. Removing names alone may leave identifying details in a story, so do not assume that renamed records are anonymous.

Question — is the review meaningful?

“A human checks it” leaves several questions unanswered. Does that person understand the task, have time to inspect the result and have authority to change it? Can the affected person reach someone if the outcome is wrong?

The consequences matter. Suggesting alternative event titles is different from sending invitations, publishing people's details or deciding who receives a limited place. A successful small writing exercise does not establish readiness for those other uses.

Arun asks whether a plain manual grouping would be easier. Choosing a simple method can be a reasonable decision. He also asks how to recover if a tool changes or becomes unavailable.

Decide — make the boundary concrete

Arun chooses to practise with invented suggestions and compare the grouping manually. He will not upload the participant spreadsheet while the approved process is unclear. He asks the organiser what information and tools may be used for the actual task.

His boundary is specific:

“Use the supplied fictional cards to suggest groups. Keep every idea visible. Do not rank people or send anything. I will check the groups before choosing what to recommend.”

The organisation remains responsible for its process, resources and decisions. A boundary written by one volunteer is only one part of that arrangement.

Your turn — keep the purpose and the people in view

Use these fictional suggestion cards. The letters identify cards, not people:

A: A quiet drawing session. **B:** A beginner bicycle-care demonstration. **C:** Drawing with large-print instructions. **D:** A conversation about repairing clothes.

An invented assistant response groups B and D as “practical skills” and drops A and C as “less useful.” It proposes emailing participants to announce that decision.

1. Explain two ways the response goes beyond the brief.
2. Propose a grouping that retains all four ideas.
3. Name a question the organiser should settle before choosing activities.
4. State one condition that would make you pause this use of AI.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

The response ranks and drops suggestions without authority, and proposes sending an announcement. One grouping is “drawing: A and C” and “repair and care: B and D.” Keep the quiet setting and large-print request visible rather than flattening them into a generic drawing category.

The organiser could ask about access needs, available instructors, time and space before choosing. A reasonable pause condition is discovering that important requests keep disappearing, that review is impractical or that the information is not approved for the tool. Different groupings can work if they preserve the meaning.

Try a different situation

The centre now asks the tool to select six people for a limited workshop from twelve applicants. It proposes using how polished each application sounds. The information is approved for the tool, and a staff member is available to check.

Do those two facts settle whether the selection method is appropriate? What needs deciding first?

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

No. The purpose and allocation criteria need agreement. Polished writing may be unrelated to who the workshop is intended to serve and may reflect different language or support opportunities. Ask what a fair allocation should consider, how the reviewer can question the result and how applicants can seek a correction. A transparent non-AI method may be suitable. Permission to process information does not settle whether a decision rule is reasonable.

Take it with you

Use the [responsibility worksheet](#). Describe the task, necessary information, affected people, review, correction and a reason to pause. You are explaining a practical boundary, not certifying a tool as suitable for every use.

[Previous: Skills worth developing](#) · [Next: Your next 30 days](#) · [Course home](#)

Your next 30 days

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Lesson 8 of 8 · Adult beginners · About 35–45 minutes for the final case and plan

By the end: you can combine the course's questions into a reasoned proposal, choose a manageable learning goal and decide what to keep or change after practice.

Thirty days is a convenient planning window. You can stretch it, shorten it or pause. The aim is a useful next step that fits your life.

Begin with something you care about

Lina wants to explain a workshop update clearly. Arun, a community volunteer, wants to turn a short list of confirmed event details into a useful notice. They have different responsibilities but can practise the same habit.

“Become excellent at AI” gives neither person a clear next action. “Write a notice that preserves all the supplied facts and marks missing information” is something they can attempt and check.

Learn — choose a small goal

Start with something you already understand enough to evaluate. Your goal might involve writing, organising information, learning a topic or making something creative.

Write down:

- **The task:** what you want to do.
- **The evidence:** what you will check it against.
- **The skill:** what you want to remain able to do yourself.

For Arun: “I will turn supplied event notes into a clear notice, compare every detail with the notes and explain my changes without reopening the sample answer.”

This course's plan is a practice aid, not a promise about how fast someone learns.

Question — decide what would count as progress

A polished page can hide mistakes. So can a familiar exercise that you remember. Plan to try a changed example as well as the first one.

Ask:

1. Did I preserve the facts and notice what was missing?
2. Can I explain my decisions in my own words?
3. Does this help with a task that matters to me?
4. What time, support or access do I need?

Keep only useful learning notes. You can use the supplied invented material throughout.

Decide — make a flexible plan

When	Small action	What to keep
Days 1–7	Try one task yourself and compare it with the supplied facts	A starting example and one question
Days 8–14	Study feedback; revise the task using a person, reference or optional AI assistance	A correction and the reason for it
Days 15–21	Try a different example, then explain your work without the sample	Evidence of what you can now do
Days 22–30	Review usefulness, effort and remaining difficulty	A decision to continue, change, pause or stop

Choose a pace with room for the rest of your life. If a tool is unavailable, you can compare with the answer guidance or ask a willing supporter. An independent explanation can be spoken or written.

Worked plan — Arun's event notice

Arun chooses two short practice sessions each week. The number is his preference, not a requirement.

His starting attempt includes a booking claim that the notes do not support. He marks it and asks, “How can I make unknown details clear?” After studying an example, he replaces the claim with a question for the organiser.

Later, he writes from a different fact card without looking at the earlier answer. He checks the date, time, place, cost and missing information. At the end of the month, he decides whether this practice has made his notices easier to check.

If he keeps making the same mistake, he can narrow the task to separating known and unknown details. That is useful information for choosing the next practice.

Your turn — build and test your plan

Complete the [30-day worksheet](#). Name a task, one check, a source of help, a fresh example and a reason you might change course.

Then try this fictional starting task:

Riverside reading circle: 18 August, 14:00–14:45, Oak Room. Bring one book. Entry is

free. The organiser has not supplied booking information.

Write a two-sentence notice. Keep missing booking information visible. Compare your draft before reading the example.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

One answer: “Join the free Riverside reading circle on 18 August, 14:00–14:45, in Oak Room and bring one book. Booking information is still to be confirmed.”

Check the five supplied details and the unresolved booking question. Different wording works if it preserves them. In a real announcement, a year and full location may also be needed.

Try a different situation

The organiser now confirms: “Book in advance; the meeting moves to Pine Room and starts at 15:00. The date, free entry and book instruction stay the same.” No revised finish time is given.

Write an updated notice. What new uncertainty should you notice?

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

Use 18 August, 15:00, Pine Room, free entry, bring one book, and advance booking. The finish time is now unconfirmed: do not automatically keep 14:45 or invent 15:45.

One answer: “Join the free Riverside reading circle on 18 August at 15:00 in Pine Room; book in advance and bring one book. The finish time is still to be confirmed.”

This changed example checks whether you reconsider the facts when conditions change.

Bring the course together

Use this final fictional case. It brings together a useful task, a shared service and a learning goal:

Riverside wants to use AI to group suggestions for new community classes. Staff spend about two hours each week grouping them manually. Suggestions arrive through an app and on paper. The centre has not measured the time needed to check AI groupings. Some suggestions include personal details and access needs. The organiser proposes trying the idea before making a long-term decision.

Prepare a short proposal using the final worksheet. You can write six sentences or explain them aloud:

1. Name one useful task to try and a clear boundary.

2. Describe information suitable for the first practice.
3. Identify a possible benefit and a burden to examine.
4. Name a perspective that should be included.
5. Propose a fair comparison and a skill someone could practise.
6. State a review point and evidence that could change your recommendation.

There is no requirement to recommend AI. Give reasons for your proposal before opening the example.

Answer guidance — Compare your reasoning

One proposal is: “Try grouping invented suggestions while keeping every suggestion visible; do not choose classes or send announcements. Practise on fictional cards before deciding how actual information may be handled. A possible benefit is easier sorting, but missing requests and checking time need examination. Include people who use paper and staff who arrange accessible activities. Compare manual and assisted grouping on the same invented set, counting checking and corrections as well as drafting, and practise explaining the categories. Review after two small practice sessions; pause or revise if important requests disappear or the effort is not worthwhile.”

The review point is an editorial choice for this example. An equally reasonable proposal could improve the manual process first, or postpone the experiment until review time is available. Support your choice with the supplied facts and make uncertainties explicit. A successful fictional exercise alone would not justify deployment with actual participant information.

Your final choice

Finish your plan with: “I will try ___ because ___. I will check ___ on ___. If ___, I will change ___.”

You decide what is useful enough to continue. Learning may lead you to use AI, use it differently, ask for better support or choose another method. The point is greater understanding and a choice you can explain.

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

[Previous: Responsibility and choice](#) · [Worksheets](#) · [Course home](#)

Your choice workbook

[Course home](#)

Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.

Use paper, a local document or a conversation with a willing supporter. Keep your notes for yourself. The supplied fictional stories are enough for every activity.

My choice

For [lesson 1](#).

Learn	Your notes
What am I trying to do?	
Which facts have I been given?	
What could a tool or another person help with?	

Question	Your notes
What supports the answer?	
What is missing or contradicted?	
Who could be affected?	

Decide	Your notes
What will I do, and why?	
What needs checking or clarification first?	
What new information could change my choice?	

My task brief

For lesson 2.

Part	My notes
Purpose and people	
Supplied information	
Boundaries and materials	
Desired result	
How I will check it	
What changed after feedback?	

My evidence check

For lesson 3.

Question	My notes
What exactly is the claim?	
Where did it originate, and when?	
What does the source actually support?	
Are later reports independent or repeating it?	
What remains uncertain?	
What will I say or do now?	

My work and skills

For lesson 4. Use the invented repair shop, volunteering or another role you understand. Leave private workplace details out.

Task	Assistance to explore	Skill I will practise	How I will check it

A question for the people organising this work: _____

Who might benefit, and who might face extra work or barriers? _____

One change that could make the arrangement better: _____

Our shared choice

For lesson 5.

Question	My notes
What shared service or decision are we considering?	
Who might benefit?	
Who might be missing or face extra burdens?	
What does the evidence measure—and leave out?	
Which values or trade-offs need discussion?	
What change or alternative do I propose?	
Who can decide, explain and correct it?	
What evidence could change my view?	

My skill practice

For lesson 6.

Step	My notes
A skill useful to me	
My first attempt	
Help or feedback I used	
What I can explain in my own words	
A changed example to try	
What I noticed and will practise next	

My responsibility check

For lesson 7.

Question	My notes
What is the exact task?	
What information is necessary and permitted?	
Who could be affected or should have a say?	
What actions are allowed?	
Who can review, change or stop the result?	
How can a mistake be corrected?	
What would make me pause or choose another method?	

My next 30 days

For lesson 8.

My goal: _____

The skill I want to keep independently: _____

The facts, reference or person that can help me check: _____

Stage	My small action	Evidence I will look for
Learn: try a starting task		
Question: examine and revise		
Learn again: try a changed example		
Decide: review what helped		

If access, time or support changes, my alternative is: _____

My review date or occasion: _____

My decision: continue / change / pause / stop

My reason: _____

Something I can now explain without the sample: _____

Changing a plan after learning something new is part of making a thoughtful choice.

Bringing it together

For the final case in lesson 8.

My proposal	My notes
One useful task to try	
Information and clear boundaries	
A benefit and a burden to examine	
A missing perspective or shared question	
A fair comparison and a skill to practise	
A review point and a reason to change course	

Finish aloud or in writing: “I recommend ___ because ___. I would change this recommendation if ___.”

Words used in this course

Course home

These are plain-language teaching explanations. Return to a lesson for an example; you do not need to memorise the list.

Word	Meaning here
AI	Computer systems that use inputs to produce outputs such as predictions, recommendations or generated content
Generative AI	AI that can produce content such as words or pictures
Prompt	An instruction or question given to an AI system
Task brief	The purpose, supplied information, boundaries, desired result and checks for a task
Evidence	Information used to support or challenge a particular claim
Source	Where information came from; examine its context and support as well as its identity
Independent confirmation	Support that does not merely repeat the same original claim
Uncertainty	Something not established or not known with enough confidence for the decision
Scenario	A possible situation used to explore choices; it is not a prediction that it will happen
Task exposure	The possibility that a task could be affected by a technology's capabilities; not a prediction of job loss
Representation	Whose experiences or responses appear in information, and whose are missing
Trade-off	A choice where improving one thing may involve giving up or changing another
Mean or average	A total divided by the number of items included; always explain which items count

Word	Meaning here
Accountability	A practical arrangement for explaining decisions, taking responsibility and addressing problems
Human review	A person examines the work with the knowledge, time and authority needed to question or change it
Transfer task	A changed example that checks whether you can use an idea beyond the sample

Sources and editorial notes explain the research foundations and the limits of these simplified definitions.

Sources and editorial notes

Review date: 6 October 2026. [Course home](#)

Existing educational foundation

This course develops the task selection, checking, independent practice and conditional-futures approach in [AI Introduction](#), by Massoud Fattahi. Existing adult-course snapshot reviewed: 6c4f0ae874b62ae99d1cf1dde9ee3dbb9b8aca83.

Related original lessons: [clear instructions](#), [checking results](#), [learning and growth](#), and [future scenarios](#).

“Your choices matter. Learn. Question. Decide.” is the central message and teaching sequence. The course connects individual learning with decisions about work and shared services.

Claim and source record

Claim or material	Source	Scope
Generative systems can present false content confidently	NIST AI 600-1, July 2024, section 2.2	Supports checking important claims; no evaluation of this course or a specific tool
Work can be examined at the level of tasks within occupations	ILO Working Paper 140, 20 May 2025	Supports the task-based framing; the shop map is our illustration, not an ILO occupational assessment
Exposure measures alone do not predict actual job losses	ILO, 17 April 2026	Adoption, feasibility and wider conditions affect outcomes; no personal job forecast follows
Plain introductory AI definition	OECD explanatory memorandum, 2024 , also used in the existing adult course	Simplified teaching explanation; not a legal classification
Trustworthiness involves context, organisations, privacy, accountability and reliable performance	NIST AI RMF 1.0, 2023, section 3	Background for lessons 5 and 7; the page notes a revision is in progress, and this course cites the identified 1.0 text
AI ethics includes fairness, human oversight, inclusion and environmental concerns	UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of AI, adopted 2021	Broad educational framing for lesson 5; not a statement of a particular jurisdiction's law

All stories, notices, work maps, timings, answer keys and possible organisational choices are invented teaching material, drafted with AI assistance and checked during authoring. They are not measured AI outputs or results from a real workplace.

Teaching choices and limits

The Learn–Question–Decide sequence, practice cycle, 30-day plan, final case and completion-time estimates are editorial choices. Learner effectiveness and reading-level suitability have not yet been tested. The facilitator guide proposes a review method.

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Assets and versions

The visual preview uses original HTML/CSS composition and live-text sequences made for this course; no third-party photograph, icon library or remote font is included. Teaching text remains in Markdown. Edition: full adult course 0.2.1, published 6 October 2026.

Keeping the material current

When revising an edition, recheck dated claims against the identified official sources and distinguish a changed source from a changed interpretation. Review examples when a reader reports a misleading assumption or unclear answer. Keep the edition, source record, Markdown and generated reading/print copies together. Do not describe a revised edition as learner-tested without evidence from that edition.

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